

film reviews

The Half Moon

KHOYA KHOYA CHAND

Director: Sudhir Mishra
Starring: Soha Ali Khan, Shiney Ahuja

This is a movie one wants to like primarily because it recreates Bollywood's golden era. Clearly Mishra knows his Bimal Roy from his Guru Dutt and his musicians have created a score that any '50s filmmaker would be proud to claim as his own. But in investing young Soha Ali Khan with the combined virtues of Madhubala, Meena Kumari and Waheeda Rehman, he has perhaps overestimated her talent.

The movie is a woman's tale, common to many of the actors



RETRO MOOD: Khan and Ahuja in *Khoya Khoya Chand* who worked in the Bollywood of that time, daughters of courtesans, beginning as child actors, having to feed entire families and falling into a succession of eternally doomed relationships.

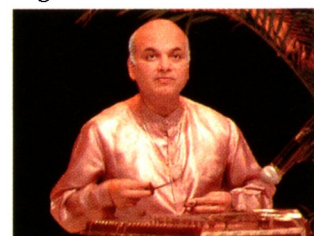
Mishra has a penchant for creating strong women and the '50s had an array

of them. But take away the searing cameos, from a sensuous Sonya Jehan whose charms are said to be fading, to a pugnacious Punjabi producer played by Saurabh Shukla, and the film is just a collection of gorgeous fabrics, smoky sets and haunting melodies. **by Kaveree Bamzai**

recommendations

Pure Tradition

KOLKATA At the Gunidas Sangeet Sammelan on December 15-16, musicians pay tribute to Pandit Jagannathbua Purohit.



Vyas on santoor

Keeping the pure classical tradition alive, the festival presents both young and established artistes. It opens with a vocal recital by Kaushiki Chakraborty, followed by Shahid Parvez on sitar. On the second day enjoy the magic of santoor by Satish Vyas and a vocal recital by Rashid Khan. At the G.D. Birla Sabaghar.

Tedious Ten

DUS KAHANIYAN

Directors: Sanjay Gupta, Rohit Roy, Meghna Gulzar, Apoorva Lakhia
Starring: Shabana Azmi, Naseeruddin Shah and Nana Patekar

The man says "I love you". The woman says, "Please don't say that. It makes our relationship look ordinary." Another man tells a girl who has just walked into his cottage, "*Kuch sawalon ke jawab nahin hote* (some questions have no answers)." Yet another tells his buddy, "don't be a relationship junkie". All these profundities find their way into the 10 stories that make *Dus Kahaniyan*, a collection of short films by six directors.

There are some fine actors walking through the



SLICE OF LIFE: Tales of love and angst in *Dus Kahaniyan* frames, from Shabana Azmi to Naseeruddin Shah, from Nana Patekar to Manoj Bajpai. But there is no uniformity of style or structure. While a few stories look like leftovers from Ram Gopal Varma's *Darna Mana Hai* series, yet others look like they belong to Doordarshan's classic *Kathasagar* series. Are the stories about urban angst or about the afterlife? Despite a gold bikini sporting Tareena Patel and a finger-licking Neha Dhupia, the movie provides no answers. **by Kaveree Bamzai**

DELHI Fast footwork, crisp anarkali kurtas and the jhankar of ghungroos—Kathak, one of the classical dance forms of India, embodies these all. The Padatik Dance Centre of Kolkata, famous for its choreographic presentation



A Kathak presentation of Kathak, performs in the Capital on December 19 at Habitat Centre. Aaheli Chakraborty and Anasua Chaudhuri present Vividha followed by a group show Shrishti, choreographed by Chetna Jalan. At the Garden of Five Senses on December 21. **by S. Sahaya Ranjit**